

Valentin Nikolaev

Senior PHP/Laravel Backend Engineer

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Summary

Backend engineer with 15+ years of experience building production systems in PHP and Go. Hands-on Laravel, APIs, databases, CI/CD, performance, and reliability work, plus technical-lead experience. Recent work includes AI-assisted support automation and reviewing operationally sensitive backend changes.

Skills

PHP, Laravel, Symfony, Go, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, REST APIs, Git, GitHub Actions, Kubernetes, Helm, ArgoCD, AWS, RabbitMQ, microservices, event-driven systems, CI/CD, Prometheus, monitoring, system design, performance optimisation, production reliability, email delivery infrastructure, DNS, DKIM, SPF, DMARC, support automation.

Experience

Simple.life — Software Developer | Nov 2023–Jul 2026

- Designed and owned a Go support-automation platform connecting Zendesk, Intercom, and internal services.
 - Integrated AI-powered triage that automated or deflected up to 30% of inbound tickets.
 - Built resilient message-delivery paths with fallback logic, retries, and monitoring.
- Technologies: Go, Zendesk, Intercom, REST APIs, monitoring, AI-assisted automation.

CRURATED — PHP Software Developer, part-time subcontract / consulting engagement | Aug 2024–Jan 2026

- Architected event-analytics infrastructure with routing, delivery guarantees, retries, and observability. Technologies: PHP, event-driven systems, queues, AWS EventBridge, webhooks, S3, observability.

airSlate — Software Developer / Technical Lead | Feb 2021–Aug 2023

- Removed database bottlenecks, investigated API/query performance, and migrated services from ECS to Kubernetes.
- Prepared Helm, GitHub Actions, and ArgoCD workflows; built a Laravel/Symfony logger package and resolved production issues. Technologies: PHP, Laravel, Symfony, MySQL, Elasticsearch, RabbitMQ, AWS, Kubernetes, Helm, GitHub Actions, ArgoCD, Prometheus.

Hypr — Technical Lead | Nov 2019–Jan 2021

- Helped take a platform from prototype to closed beta in under six months and shaped backend, microservice, CI/CD, and reliability decisions. Technologies: PHP, Go, Laravel, MySQL, AWS, Kubernetes, microservices, REST APIs, CI/CD.

PDFfiller — Software Developer / Technical Lead | Oct 2016–Nov 2019

- Led five backend engineers building transactional-email services handling around 50 million emails monthly.
- Made technical decisions for high-volume messaging, DNS, DKIM, SPF, DMARC, and peak traffic exceeding 10x. Technologies: PHP, Laravel, MySQL, Elasticsearch, RabbitMQ, AWS, email infrastructure, DNS, REST APIs.

Education

MSc in Computer Science, National Technical University, Kharkiv, Ukraine, 2003–2008

Languages

Ukrainian (native); English (upper-intermediate / professional working in source records).